

Elena Rodriguez

UX Research Lead

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LinkedIn Dribbble Mastodon

Mixed-methods researcher helping product teams ship inclusive, evidence-based experiences. Specialist in fintech onboarding, accessibility audits, and longitudinal diary studies.

EXPERIENCE

Lead UX Researcher

Apr 2021 – May 2026

PayFlow Europe · Barcelona, Spain

Built and scaled a four-person research practice embedded in squads.

- Reduced KYC drop-off 27% after redesign informed by contextual inquiry.
- Established research ops: repository, consent templates, and incentive workflow.
- Partnered with legal on WCAG 2.2 AA compliance roadmap for mobile app.

Senior UX Researcher

2017 – Mar 2021

Design Studio Nova · Madrid, Spain

Led discovery and usability testing for public-sector digital services.

- Conducted 120+ moderated sessions for national healthcare portal redesign.
- Introduced service blueprinting workshops adopted by three ministries.

VOLUNTEER

Mentorship Coordinator

Jun 2019 – Dec 2025

Ladies That UX Barcelona

Matched early-career designers with industry mentors for portfolio and research critiques.

- Supported 85 mentees across 6 cohort cycles.
- Organized quarterly research methods lightning talks.

EDUCATION

Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Sep 2015 – Jun 2017

Master, Human-Computer Interaction · 9.2/10

- Qualitative Methods in HCI
- Accessibility and Inclusive Design
- Cognitive Ergonomics

Universidad de Sevilla

2011 – 2015

Bachelor, Psychology

- Experimental Psychology
- Statistics
- Perception and Attention

PROJECTS

Inclusive Forms Pattern Library

Aug 2022 – Nov 2023

PayFlow Europe / open source · application · Research lead, Writer, Facilitator

Open pattern library documenting accessible form components with research citations.

Accessibility, Design systems, Forms, WCAG

- 500+ GitHub stars within six months.
- Referenced in PayFlow design system v3.

Euro UX Research Meetup

Jan 2020 – Present

Ladies That UX Barcelona · presentation · Organizer, Host

Monthly meetup series featuring practitioner talks on research in product orgs.

Community, UX research, Networking

- Hosted 24 events with 150 average attendance.
- Sponsored by three local design agencies.

SKILLS

Research Methods

Master — Contextual inquiry, Diary studies, Tree testing, Card sorting, Usability testing

Research Ops

Senior — Dovetail, Optimal Workshop, Consent management, Incentive platforms

Facilitation

Senior — Workshops, Journey mapping, Stakeholder alignment, Design sprints

AWARDS

Research Impact Award

Sep 2024

PayFlow Europe

Honoured for research program that directly influenced three major product launches in 2024.

CERTIFICATES

CPACC – Certified Professional in Accessibility Core Competencies

May 2023

IAAP

NN/g UX Certification

Feb 2020

Nielsen Norman Group

PUBLICATIONS

Diary Studies at Scale in Regulated Industries

Jan 2025

UX Collective

How to run asynchronous longitudinal research without compromising participant privacy.

LANGUAGES

Spanish — Native

Catalan — Professional
English — Fluent
Portuguese — Beginner

INTERESTS

Ceramics

Wheel throwing, Glazing, Studio pottery

Urban Sketching

Watercolour, Architecture, Plein air

REFERENCES

Miguel Santos

Elena elevates every product conversation with clear, actionable insights. Her research practice is a model for embedding UX in agile fintech teams.